

Identity Why are Lebanese Christians Canaanites

By Mr Toni Atieh Hadchiti

In my post, I clearly stated that all Christians in Lebanon from other cultures, are living the Canaanite worldliness / culture / dunya and have assimilated into it. We are the rightful owners of this land, and whoever comes to us and lives among us on our land will be assimilated into us even if they retain a little of their distinct identity (like Little China in America).

I would like to mention a family friend of mine from Koura, the Kozma family. We have known them for fifty years, before I was even born. This family is of Greek origin, but even they have forgotten when they came to Lebanon and do not consider anything to be connecting them to Greece. They belong to Canaanite political parties, fought with these parties in the war, and their causes to be the causes of the Canaanite people.

There is no current culture among Lebanese Christians other than the Canaanite one. Of course, like all cultures in the world, cultural elements evolve over time and through contact with other peoples. And no matter how much a culture undergoes transformations, developments, and modernizations, it remains fundamentally the same. Not every time we come into contact with another people do we abandon our identity and name and become one of them. Not every time we are occupied does our name change, and we become extinct and disappear, as some like to portray it.

You, Mr. X, when you were 7 years old, penniless, and knew only one language, you were X. And when you reached 30, fluent in three languages, with a bank account, university degrees, married, owning property, a job, a car (which you learned to drive), and having traveled to 10 countries, you were still X, not someone else with a different name.

- Christianity is not a culture / dunya / worliness, it does not define an ethnicity (qawmiyya) / People (sha3b) / and evenless so a civilization. Christianity is a faith. Therefore, according to sociology, a culture cannot be monolithic. That's why we always say, in this way, that we are a Canaanite people, not a Christian people or a Canaanite-Christian people.

As a Christian in Lebanon, my culture is completely different and has no connection whatsoever with the Christians of Nigeria for example. Their customs and traditions are different, our tastes are different, our cuisine is different, our clothing is different.

Speaking of Africa, let me mention an important incident there: one tribe had polygamy as a normal practice. When they become christian, they faced a dilemma regarding marriage. Ultimately, the Church issued a recommendation that they respect their identity and traditions, stating that Christian teachings do not interfere in the lives of peoples, but the memorandum encouraged them to practice monogamy.

In Switzerland, four peoples (all Christians) fought for 500 years. While they are all Christians, they are four peoples, representing four cultures.

- For 6,000 years, we have known ourselves as Canaanites. No matter what other names and titles we are known by, we must hold fast to our original name. My name is Tony, not Anton, Antoine, Tanios, Tanos, or Anthony. The Greeks called us Phoenicians because of the red marks that stained our skin from the purple dye.

- When our Canaanite people were introduced to Christianity, their entire culture didn't change. Only the faith changed; everything else — every aspect of life, their worldliness — remained Canaanite... and evolved.